

Medieval History — UPSC Prelims PYQ

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— 2025 —

UPSC 2025

Medieval History › Medieval India

moderate

Q75. Consider the following fruits :

I. Papaya

II. Pineapple

III. Guava

How many of the above were introduced in India by the Portuguese in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All the three**
- (d) None

Answer: (c)

— 2024 —

UPSC 2024

Medieval History › Medieval India

moderate

Q56. Who of the following rulers of medieval India gave permission to the Portuguese to build a fort at Bhatkal ?

- (a) Krishnadevaraya**
- (b) Narasimha Saluva
- (c) Muhammad Shah III
- (d) Yusuf Adil Shah

Answer: (a)

— 2023 —

UPSC 2023

Medieval History › South Indian Dynasties

difficult

Q45. Consider the following dynasties :

1. Hoysala
2. Gahadavala
3. Kakatiya
4. Yadava

How many of the above dynasties established their kingdoms in early eighth century AD?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) None**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2023

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q48. Who among the following rulers of Vijayanagara Empire constructed a large dam across Tungabhadra River and a canal-cum-aqueduct several kilometres long from the river to the capital city?

- (a) Devaraya I**
- (b) Mallikarjuna
- (c) Vira Vijaya
- (d) Virupaksha

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2023

Medieval History › Regional Kingdoms & Frontier States

moderate

Q49. Who among the following rulers of medieval Gujarat surrendered Diu to Portuguese?

- (a) Ahmad Shah
- (b) Mahmud Begarha
- (c) Bahadur Shah**
- (d) Muhammad Shah

Answer: (c)

— 2022 —

UPSC 2022

Medieval History › Medieval India

moderate

Q52. In medieval India, the term "Fanam" referred to :

- (a) Clothing
- (b) Coins**
- (c) Ornaments
- (d) Weapons

Answer: (b)

Q57. With reference to Indian history, consider the following statements :

1. The first Mongol invasion of India happened during the reign of Jalal-ud-din Khalji.
2. During the reign of Ala-ud-din Khalji, one Mongol assault marched up to Delhi and besieged the city.
3. Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq temporarily lost portions of north-west of his kingdom to Mongols.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

Q58. With reference to Indian history, who of the following were known as "Kulah-Daran" ?

- (a) Arab merchants
- (b) Qalandars
- (c) Persian calligraphists
- (d) Sayyids**

Answer: (d)

Q92. Consider the following pairs :

King : Dynasty

1. Nannuka — Chandela
2. Jayashakti — Paramara
3. Nagabhata II — Gurjara-Pratihara
4. Bhoja — Rashtrakuta

How many pairs given above are correctly matched ?

- (a) Only one pair
- (b) Only two pairs**
- (c) Only three pairs
- (d) All four pairs

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2022

Medieval History › Medieval Culture & Historiography

easy

Q94. "Yogavāsistha" was translated into Persian by Nizamuddin Panipati during the reign of :

- (a) Akbar**
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2022

Medieval History › Bhakti Movement

easy

Q95. The world's second tallest statue in sitting pose of Ramanuja was inaugurated by the Prime Minister of India at Hyderabad recently. Which one of the following statements correctly represents the teachings of Ramanuja ?

- (a) The best means of salvation was devotion.**
- (b) Vedas are eternal, self-existent and wholly authoritative.
- (c) Logical arguments were essential means for the highest bliss.
- (d) Salvation was to be obtained through meditation.

Answer: (a)

— 2021 —

UPSC 2021

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q35. According to Portuguese writer Nuniz, the women in Vijayanagara Empire were expert in which of the following areas?

- 1. Wrestling
- 2. Astrology
- 3. Accounting
- 4. Soothsaying

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

Q38. Consider the following statements :

1. It was during the reign of Iltutmish that Chengiz Khan reached the Indus in pursuit of the fugitive Khwarezm prince.
2. It was during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughluq that Taimur occupied Multan and crossed the Indus.
3. It was during the reign of Deva Raya II of Vijayanagara Empire that Vasco da Gama reached the coast of Kerala.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q45. With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

- (a) Paragana—Sarkar—Suba
- (b) Sarkar—Paragana—Suba
- (c) Suba—Sarkar—Paragana
- (d) Paragana—Suba—Sarkar

Answer: (a)

— 2020 —

**Q97. With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs :
Famous Place — Present State**

1. Bhilsa — Madhya Pradesh
2. Dwarasamudra — Maharashtra
3. Girinagar — Gujarat
4. Sthanesvara — Uttar Pradesh

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 4 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 2 and 4 only

Answer: (a)

— 2019 —

Q1. With reference to Mughal India, what is/are the difference/differences between Jagirdar and Zamindar?

1. Jagirdars were holders of land assignments in lieu of judicial and police duties, whereas Zamindars were holders of revenue rights without obligation to perform any duty other than revenue collection.
2. Land assignments to Jagirdars were hereditary and revenue rights of Zamindars were not hereditary.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

Q12. Consider the following statements :

1. In the revenue administration of Delhi Sultanate, the in-charge of revenue collection was known as 'Amil'.
2. The Iqta system of Sultans of Delhi was an ancient indigenous institution.
3. The office of 'Mir Bakshi' came into existence during the reign of Khalji Sultans of Delhi.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only**
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

Q13. Consider the following statements :

1. Saint Nimbarka was a contemporary of Akbar.
2. Saint Kabir was greatly influenced by Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2018

Medieval History › Medieval Culture & Historiography

easy

Q73. Which one of the following foreign travellers elaborately discussed about diamonds and diamond mines of India ?

- (a) Francois Bernier
- (b) Jean-Baptiste Tavernier**
- (c) Jean de Thevenot
- (d) Abbe Barthelemy Carre

Answer: (b)

— 2017 —

UPSC 2017

Medieval History › South Indian Dynasties

moderate

Q51. Which one of the following was a very important seaport in the Kakatiya kingdom ?

- (a) Kakinada
- (b) Motupalli**
- (c) Machilipatnam (Masulipatnam)
- (d) Nelluru

Answer: (b)

— 2016 —

UPSC 2016

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q9. Regarding the taxation system of Krishna Deva, the ruler of Vijayanagar, consider the following statements :

- 1. The tax rate on land was fixed depending on the quality of the land.**
- 2. Private owners of workshops paid an industries tax.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2016

Medieval History › Bhakti Movement

moderate

Q17. With reference to the cultural history of medieval India, consider the following statements :

- 1. Siddhas (Sittars) of Tamil region were monotheistic and condemned idolatry.**
 - 2. Lingayats of Kannada region questioned the theory of rebirth and rejected the caste hierarchy.**
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2**
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2016

Medieval History › Medieval Administration & Socio-Economic Institutions

easy

Q38. Banjaras during the medieval period of Indian history were generally

(a) agriculturists

(b) warriors

(c) weavers

(d) traders

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2016

Medieval History › South Indian Dynasties

moderate

**Q80. In the context of the history of India, consider the following pairs :
Term**

1. Eripatti : Land, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of the village tank

2. Taniyurs : Villages donated to a single Brahmin or a group of Brahmins

3. Ghatikas : Colleges generally attached to the temples

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2

(b) 3 only

(c) 2 and 3

(d) 1 and 3

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2016

Medieval History › Medieval Administration & Socio-Economic Institutions

moderate

Q88. With reference to the economic history of medieval India, the term 'Araghatta' refers to

(a) bonded labour

(b) land grants made to military officers

(c) waterwheel used in the irrigation of land

(d) wasteland converted to cultivated land

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Medieval History › Regional Kingdoms & Frontier States

difficult

Q35. Consider the following pairs :

Medieval Indian State Present Region

1. Champaka : Central India

2. Durgara : Jammu

3. Kuluta : Malabar

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2

(b) 2 only

(c) 1 and 3

(d) 3 only

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q41. Consider the following :

The arrival of Babur into India led to the

1. introduction of gunpowder in the subcontinent

2. introduction of the arch and dome in the region's architecture

3. establishment of Timurid dynasty in the region

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2015

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q47. Who of the following founded a new city on the south bank of a tributary to river Krishna and undertook to rule his new kingdom as the agent of a deity to whom all the land south of the river Krishna was supposed to belong?

(a) Amoghavarsha I

(b) Ballala II

(c) Harihara I

(d) Prataparudra II

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2015

Medieval History › Medieval Administration & Socio-Economic Institutions

moderate

Q55. With reference to Indian history, which of the following is/are the essential element/elements of the feudal system?

1. A very strong centralized political authority and a very weak provincial or local political authority
2. Emergence of administrative structure based on control and possession of land
3. Creation of lord-vassal relationship between the feudal lord and his overlord

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only**
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

— 2014 —

UPSC 2014

Medieval History › Medieval Administration & Socio-Economic Institutions

moderate

Q21. In medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for

- (a) military officers
- (b) village headmen**
- (c) specialists in Vedic rituals
- (d) chiefs of craft guilds

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2014

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

easy

Q93. Ibadat Khana at Fatehpur Sikri was

- (a) the mosque for the use of Royal Family
- (b) Akbar's private prayer chamber
- (c) the hall in which Akbar held discussions with scholars of various religions**
- (d) the room in which the nobles belonging to different religions gathered to discuss religious affairs

Answer: (c)

— 2013 —

UPSC 2013

Medieval History › Bhakti Movement

moderate

Q52. Consider the following Bhakti Saints :

1. Dadu Dayal

2. Guru Nanak

3. Tyagaraja Who among the above was/were preaching when the Lodi dynasty fell and Babur took over?

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 2 only**
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 1 and 2

Answer: (b)

— 2012 —

UPSC 2012

Medieval History › Sufism

moderate

Q69. With reference to the religious history of medieval India, the Sufi mystics were known to pursue which of the following practices?

1. Meditation and control of breath

2. Severe ascetic exercises in a lonely place

3. Recitation of holy songs to arouse a state of ecstasy in their audience

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3**

Answer: (d)

— 2009 —

UPSC 2009

Medieval History › European Powers & Early Colonial Contacts

easy

Q64. With whose permission did the English set up their first factory in Surat?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir**
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (b)

— 2008 —

UPSC 2008

Medieval History › European Powers & Early Colonial Contacts

easy

Q56. During the time of which Mughal Emperor did the English East India Company establish its first factory in India?

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir**
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb

Answer: (b)

— 2006 —

UPSC 2006

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q20. Assertion (A): Muhammad bin Tughlaq issued a new gold coin which was called Dinar by Ibn Batutah.

Reason (R): Muhammad bin Tughlaq wanted to issue token currency in gold coins to promote trade with West Asian and North African countries.

- (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false**
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

easy

Q74. Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the Afghan rulers to the throne of Delhi?

- (a) Sikandar Shah-Ibrahim Lodi-Bahlol Khan Lodi
- (b) Sikandar Shah-Bahlol Khan Lodi-Ibrahim Lodi
- (c) Bahlol Khan Lodi-Sikandar Shah-Ibrahim Lodi**
- (d) Bahlol Khan Lodi-Ibrahim Lodi-Sikandar Shah

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2006

Medieval History › Medieval Culture & Historiography

easy

Q76. In Indian history, who was Abdul Hamid Lahori?

- (a) An important military commander during Akbar's reign
- (b) An official historian of the reign of Shah Jahan**
- (c) An important noble and confidant of Aurangzeb
- (d) A chronicler and poet during the reign of Muhammad Shah

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2006

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q127. When Raja Wodeyar founded the kingdom of Mysore, who was the ruler of the Vijayanagar Empire?

- (a) Sadasiva
- (b) Tirumala
- (c) Ranga II
- (d) Venkata II**

Answer: (d)

— 2005 —

UPSC 2005

Medieval History › European Powers & Early Colonial Contacts

moderate

Q36. Which one of the following is the correct statement?

- (a) The modern Kochi was a Dutch colony till India's independence.
- (b) The Dutch defeated the Portuguese and built Fort Williams in the modern Kochi.**
- (c) The modern Kochi was first a Dutch colony before the Portuguese took over from them.
- (d) The modern Kochi never became a part of the British colony.

Answer: (b)

— 2004 —

UPSC 2004

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q2. Consider the following statements:

1. Narasimha Saluva ended the Sangama dynasty and seized the throne for himself and started the Saluva dynasty.
2. Vira Narasimha deposed the last Saluva ruler and seized the throne for himself.
3. Vira Narasimha was succeeded by his younger brother, Krishnadeva Raya.
4. Krishnadeva Raya was succeeded by his half-brother, Achyuta Raya.

Which of these statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 2, 3 and 4
- (c) 1 and 4
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2004

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q18. Who was the last ruler of the Tughlaq dynasty of the Delhi Sultanate?

- (a) Firoj Shah Tughlaq
- (b) Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq Shah II
- (c) Nasir-ud-din Mahmud**
- (d) Nasrat Shah

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2004

Medieval History › Regional Kingdoms & Frontier States

moderate

Q25. How did the dynasty of Nizam Shahis of Ahmadnagar come to an end?

- (a) Ahmadnagar was annexed into Mughal empire and Husain Shah was consigned to life imprisonment**
- (b) Mughal troops destroyed Daulatabad fort and killed Nizam-ul-Mulk of Ahmadnagar
- (c) Fateh Khan usurped the throne from Nizam-ul-Mulk
- (d) Malik Ambar was defeated in a battle with Mughals in 1631 and the entire royal family was killed by the Mughal troops

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2004

Medieval History › Regional Kingdoms & Frontier States

moderate

Q120. Consider the following statements about Sikh Gurus:

1. Banda Bahadur was appointed as the military leader of the Sikhs by Guru Tegh Bahadur.
2. Guru Arjun Dev became the Sikh Guru after Guru Ram Das.
3. Guru Arjun Dev gave to Sikhs their own script – Guru mukhi.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3**
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) 1 and 2

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q1. Alam Khan, one of those who invited Babar to invade India was

(a) An uncle of Ibrahim Lodi and a pretender to the throne of Delhi

(b) A cousin of Ibrahim Lodi who was ill-treated and expelled from the country

(c) The father of Dilawar Khan to whom cruel treatment was meted out by Ibrahim Lodi

(d) A high official in Punjab province who was very much discontented with Ibrahim Lodi's treatment to his tribe

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q2. The battle of Dharmat was fought between

(a) Muhammad Gori and Jai Chand

(b) Babar and the Afghans

(c) Aurangzeb and Dara Shikoh

(d) Ahmad Shah Durrani and the Marathas

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q16. How did the Mughal Emperor Jahandar Shah's reign come to an early end?

(a) He was deposed by his wazir

(b) He died due to a slip while climbing down steps

(c) He was defeated by his nephew in a battle

(d) He died of sickness due to too much consumption of wine

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › South Indian Dynasties

moderate

Q30. Consider the following statements:

1. The Cholas defeated Pandya and Chera rulers and established their domination over peninsular India in early medieval times.

2. The Cholas sent an expedition against the Sailendra empire of South-East Asia and conquered some of the areas.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

(a) Only 1

(b) Only 2

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q101. Assertion (A): Emperor Akbar marched towards Afghanistan in 1581 with a huge army.

Reason (R): He was on his way to reclaim his ancestral country of Ferghana in Central Asia.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false**
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Vijayanagara Empire

moderate

Q114. Assertion (A): Saluva Narasimha put an end to the old dynasty and assumed the royal title.

Reason (R): He wanted to save the kingdom from further degeneration and disintegration.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A**
- (b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2003

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

easy

Q125. How did Sultan Qutb-ud-din Aibak die?

- (a) He was treacherously stabbed to death by one of his ambitious nobles
- (b) He was killed in a battle with Taj-u-din Yildiz, the ruler of Ghazni who entered into a contest with him over the capture of Punjab
- (c) He sustained injuries while besieging the fortress of Kalinjar in Bundelkhand and succumbed to death later
- (d) He died after a fall from his horse while playing Chaugan**

Answer: (d)

— 2002 —

UPSC 2002

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q5. The historian Barani refused to consider the state in India under Delhi Sultans as truly Islamic because

- (a) the majority of the population did not follow Islam
- (b) the Muslim theologians were often disregarded
- (c) the Sultan supplemented the Muslim law by framing his own regulations**
- (d) religious freedom was accorded to non-Muslims

Answer: (c)

Q30. With reference to Sufism in Indian history, consider the following statements:

1. Shaikh Ahmad Sarhandi was a contemporary of Ibrahim Lodi
2. Shaikh Nasiruddin Chirag-i-Dehlavi was a disciple of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya
3. Aurangzeb was contemporary of Shaikh Salim Chisti
4. The Qadiri order of Sufis was first introduced in India by Shaikh Niamtullah and Makhdum Muhammad Jilani

Which of these statements are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 1 and 3
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 2 and 4**

Answer: (d)

Q49. With reference to medieval Indian rulers,

which one of the following statements is correct?

- (a) Alauddin Khalji first set up a separate Artizan's department
- (b) Balban introduced the branding system of horses of military
- (c) Muhammad bin Tughlaq was succeeded by his uncle to the Delhi throne
- (d) Firuz Tughlaq set up a separate department of slaves**

Answer: (d)

Q51. The motive behind Shahjahan's Balkh campaign was to

- (a) secure a friendly ruler in Balkh and Badakhshan which bordered Kabul**
- (b) conquer Samarkand and Farghana, the Mughal homelands
- (c) fix the Mughal frontier on the 'scientific line', the Amu Daria
- (d) expand the Mughal Empire beyond the sub-continent

Answer: (a)

UPSC 2002

Medieval History › Bhakti Movement

easy

Q99. Who among the following was the first Bhakti saint to use Hindi for the propagation of his message?

- (a) Dadu
- (b) Kabir
- (c) Ramananda**
- (d) Tulsidas

Answer: (c)

UPSC 2002

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q142. Assertion (A): Muhammad bin Tughlaq left Delhi, and, for two years lived in a camp called Swarga-dwari.

Reason (R): At that time, Delhi was ravaged by a form of plague and many people died.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A**
- (b) Both A and R are individually true but R is not a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true but R is false
- (d) A is false but R is true

Answer: (a)

— 2001 —

UPSC 2001

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q26. Assertion (A): The Battle of Khanua was certainly more decisive and significant than the First Battle of Panipat.

Reason (R): Rana Sanga, the Rajput hero, was certainly a more formidable adversary than Ibrahim Lodi.

- (a) Both A and R are individually true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are individually true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false
- (d) A is false, but R is true**

Answer: (d)

Q67. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I (Bhakti Saint)

I. Namdev

II. Kabir

III. Ravidas

IV. Sena

List II (Profession)

A) Barber

B) Weaver

C) Tailor

D) Cobbler

(a) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

(b) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

(c) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

(d) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Answer: (b)

Q83. The Mongols under Genghis Khan invaded India during the reign of

(a) Balban

(b) Feroze Tughlaq

(c) Iltutmish

(d) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Answer: (c)

Q92. Which among the following ports was called Babul Makka (Gate of Makka) during the Mughal Period?

(a) Calicut

(b) Broach

(c) Cambay

(d) Surat

Answer: (d)

UPSC 2001

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q98. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Dewan-i-bandagani ... Tughlaq**
- (b) Dewan-i-Mustakhraj ... Balban
- (c) Dewan-i-Kohi ... Alauddin Khilji
- (d) Dewan-i-Arz ... Muhammad Tughlaq

Answer: (a)

— 2000 —

UPSC 2000

Medieval History › Maratha Empire

easy

Q30. Who among the following streamlined the Maratha administration after Sambhaji?

- (a) Raja Ram
- (b) Balaji Viswanath**
- (c) Ganga Bai
- (d) Nanaji Deshmukh

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2000

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q36. The given map refers to the kingdom of

The original map is not available for this question.

- (a) Akbar at the time of capture of Khandesh in 1601**
- (b) Akbar at the time of his death in 1605
- (c) Aurangzeb at the time of capture of Hyderabad
- (d) Aurangzeb at the time of his death in 1707

Answer: (a)

Q37. Consider the following events:

I. Reign of Krishna Deva Raya of Vijayanagara.

II. Construction of Qutab Minar.

III. Arrival of Portuguese in India.

IV. Death of Firoz Tughlaq.

Which one of the following is the correct chronological sequence of the above events?

(a) II, IV, III, I

(b) II, IV, I, III

(c) IV, II, I, III

(d) IV, II, III, I

Answer: (a)

Q41. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List I

I. Iqta

II. Jagir

III. Amaram

IV. Mokasa

List II

A) Marathas

B) Delhi Sultans

C) Mughals

D) Vijayanagara

Codes:

(a) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

(b) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

(c) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

(d) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Answer: (b)

UPSC 2000

Medieval History › Regional Kingdoms & Frontier States

moderate

Q45. Which one of the following Muslim rulers was hailed as the 'Jagadguru' by his Muslim subjects because of his belief in secularism?

- (a) Husain Shah
- (b) Zain-ul-Abidin
- (c) Ibrahim Adil Shah**
- (d) Mahmud II

Answer: (c)

— 1999 —

UPSC 1999

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q5. "The king was freed from his people and they from their king". On whose death did Badauni comment thus?

- (a) Balban
- (b) Ala-ud-din Khalji
- (c) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq**
- (d) Feroze Shah Tughlaq

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1999

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q27. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- (a) Jahangir : William Hawkins
- (b) Akbar : Sir Thomas Roe**
- (c) Shahjahan : Tavernier
- (d) Aurangzeb : Manucci

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1999

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

difficult

Q53. To which Lodi Sultan does the given map relate and what town does the site marked A on the map represent?

The original map is not available for this question.

- (a) Behlol Lodi, Jaunpur**
- (b) Sikandar Lodi, Aligarh
- (c) Ibrahim Lodi, Jaunpur
- (d) Ibrahim Lodi, Aligarh

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1999

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q97. Assertion (A): During the time of Akbar, for every ten cavalrymen, the mansabdars had to maintain twenty horses.

Reason (R): Horses had to be rested while on march and replacements were necessary in times of war.

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A

(c) A is true, but R is false

(d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

— 1998 —

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q27. Assertion (A): At first the Turkish administration in India was essentially military.

Reason (R): The country was parcelled out as 'Iqta's among leading military leaders.

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A

(c) A is true, but R is false

(d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q34. Assertion (A): During the reign of Shahjahan, Dara Sikoh was sent on expedition to Balkha, Badakh-shan and Qandahar.

Reason (R): The expedition sent by Shahjahan to the Middle East was a marvellous success.

(a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A

(b) Both A and R are true, but R is NOT a correct explanation of A

(c) A is true, but R is false

(d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (c)

Q39. Consider the following statements: Ahadis were those troopers who

- I. Offered their services singly.**
- II. Did not attach themselves to any chief.**
- III. Had the emperor as their immediate colonel.**
- IV. Attached themselves to Mirzas.**

Of these statements:

- (a) I, II and IV are correct
- (b) I, II and III are correct**
- (c) II and III are correct
- (d) I and IV are correct

Answer: (b)

Q44. Consider the following:

- I. Tughluqabad Fort.**
- II. Lodi Garden.**
- III. Qutub Minar.**
- IV. Fatehpur Sikri.**

The correct chronological order in which they were built is:

- (a) III, I, IV, II
- (b) III, I, II, IV**
- (c) I, III, II, IV
- (d) I, III, IV, II

Answer: (b)

Q49. Match List I with List II

and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List I

I. 1556

II. 1600

III. 1686

IV. 1739

List II

A) Battle of Haldighati

B) Nadir Shah's capture of Delhi

C) Death of Shivaji

D) Grant of Charter to East India Company

E) Accession of Akbar

Codes:

(a) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

(b) I-E, II-D, III-C, IV-B

(c) I-E, II-B, III-A, IV-D

(d) I-A, II-E, III-C, IV-B

Answer: (b)

Q53. In the given map, the shaded part represents Akbar's empire at a certain juncture: 'A' stands for an independent country and 'B' marks the site of a city.

Which one of the following alternatives gives all correct information?



(a) Akbar in 1557:

(A) Golkunda

(B) Lahore

(b) Akbar in 1557:

(A) Khandesh

(B) Multan

(c) Akbar in 1605:

(A) Gondwana

(B) Multan

(d) Akbar in 1605:

(A) Gondwana

(B) Lahore

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Maratha Empire

easy

Q63. The member of Shivaji's Astha Pradhana who looked after foreign affairs was

- (a) Peshwa
- (b) Sachiv
- (c) Pandit Rao
- (d) Sumant**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

moderate

Q70. The loss of Qandahar was a big blow to the Mughal empire from the viewpoint of

- (a) Natural resources
- (b) Buffer territory
- (c) Communication
- (d) Strategic stronghold**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

moderate

Q80. Fawazil in the Sultanate period meant

- (a) Extra payment made to the nobles
- (b) Revenue assigned in lieu of salary
- (c) Excess amount paid to the exchequer by the iqtadars**
- (d) Illegal exactions extracted from the peasants

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1998

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

easy

Q88. The Sultan of Delhi who is reputed to have built the biggest network of canals in India was

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
- (c) Feroz Shah Tughlaq**
- (d) Sikandar Lodi

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1997

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

easy

Q2. After consolidating his power, Balban assumed the grand title of

- (a) Tute-i-Hind
- (b) Kaisr-i-Hind
- (c) Zil-i-Ilahi**
- (d) Din-i-Ilahi

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1997

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

easy

Q9. The head of the military department under the reorganised central machinery of administration during Akbar's reign was

- (a) Diwan
- (b) Mir Bakshi**
- (c) Mir Saman
- (d) Bakshi

Answer: (b)

UPSC 1997

Medieval History › Sufism

moderate

Q14. Assertion (A): The sponsor and the most prominent figure of the Chisti order of Sufis in India is Khwaja Moinuddin Chisti.

Reason (R): The Chisti order takes its name from a village Chisti in Ajmer.

In the context of the above two statements,

which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (b) Both A and R are true, but R is not a correct explanation of A
- (c) A is true, but R is false**
- (d) A is false, but R is true

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1997

Medieval History › Medieval Culture & Historiography

easy

Q69. The medieval Indian writer who refers to the discovery of America is

- (a) Malik Muhammad Jayasi
- (b) Amir Khusrau
- (c) Raskhan
- (d) Abul Fazl**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1996

Medieval History › Sufism

easy

Q57. The sufi saint who maintained that devotional music was one way of coming close to God was

- (a) Muin-ud-din Chishti**
- (b) Baba Farid
- (c) Saiyid Muhammad Gesudaraz
- (d) Shah Alam Bukhari

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1996

Medieval History › Mughal Empire

easy

Q86. In medieval India, Mansabdari system was introduced mainly for

- (a) making recruitment to the army**
- (b) facilitating revenue collection
- (c) ensuring religious harmony
- (d) effecting clean administration

Answer: (a)

— 1995 —

UPSC 1995

Medieval History › Medieval Culture & Historiography

moderate

Q34. Who among the following were famous jurists of medieval India?

I. Vijnanesvara

II. Hemadri

III. Rajasekhara

IV. Jimutavahana

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) I, II and III
- (b) II, III and IV
- (c) I, II and IV**
- (d) I and IV

Answer: (c)

UPSC 1995

Medieval History › Maratha Empire

easy

Q66. Ashtapradhan was a Council of Ministers

- (a) in the Gupta Administration
- (b) in the Chola Administration
- (c) in the Vijayanagar Administration
- (d) in the Maratha Administration**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Medieval History › Delhi Sultanate

difficult

Q70. Consider the map given below:

The route indicated in the map was followed, during the course of his military exploits, by



- (a) Chandragupta II
- (b) Harshavardhana
- (c) Rajendra Chola
- (d) Malik Kafur**

Answer: (d)

UPSC 1995

Medieval History › European Powers & Early Colonial Contacts

easy

Q73. Hugly was used as a base for piracy in the Bay of Bengal by

- (a) the Portuguese**
- (b) the French
- (c) the Danish
- (d) the British

Answer: (a)

UPSC 1995

Medieval History › Maratha Empire

easy

Q75. The 'Modi script' was employed in the documents of the

- (a) Wodeyars
- (b) Zamorins
- (c) Hoysalas
- (d) Marathas**

Answer: (d)